3. Had a look at the signals in the backends. In Prometheus, we plotted the overall invocations by HTTP response code, and in Jaeger, we looked at client-side error spans (containing the 403 HTTP response code).

We will get into the details of working with destinations in later chapters, but here, we focused on the instrumentation and agent aspects in the context of OpenTelemetry.

OK, that was a lot—congratulations on sticking with it! I hope this little OpenTelemetry walk-through gave you a first taste and an idea of the power that's available to you via this universal telemetry agent.

> **TIP** When it comes to OpenTelemetry distributions (http://mng.bz/a12m), there are several ways you can go about it: you can use the upstream, prebuilt distribution (http://mng.bz/gBnv) readily available, you can choose the distribution of a specific cloud provider or o11y vendor (e.g., the AWS distro [http://mng.bz/5wBB]), or you can decide to roll your own distribution using the OpenTelemetry collector Builder (http://mng.bz/5wVO), a tool provided by the project.

If you want to dive deep into OpenTelemetry, learn where it came from, what the overall vision is, and how to apply it in your setting, I recommend perusing the following books:

- Alex Boten's excellent book, *Cloud Native Observability with OpenTelemetry* (https://www.cloudnativeobservability.com/), providing you more context on OpenTelemetry and many hands-on examples.
- *Practical OpenTelemetry: Adopting Open Observability Standards Across Your Organization* by Daniel Gomez Blanco (Apess, 2023; http://mng.bz/6Dxe), which is an awesome book for learning but also for help introducing OpenTelemetry to an organization (based on his own experiences).
- *Learning OpenTelemetry* by Austin Parker and Ted Young (O'Reilly; http://mng.bz/o1gZ), the most recent book in this space, promises to be a reference book, with the two authors being driving forces behind OpenTelemetry itself.

To round off our agent review, let's have a quick look at established agents that are currently in use and may be replaced by OpenTelemetry in the future.

4.4 Other agents

In addition to the Fluent family for logs, Prometheus for metrics, and the OpenTelemetry collector as the universal telemetry agent, there are several established and widely used agents. Most of them have been written by and are distributed by cloud providers, but additionally, some observability vendors have introduced agents, so let's have a quick look at them (the same idea applies: in the fullness of time, all of them likely will be replaced by OpenTelemetry or its collector):

- Amazon CloudWatch Agent (https://github.com/aws/amazon-cloudwatch-agent/) can be used for logs and metrics, supporting AWS's proprietary embedded metric format (EMF; http://mng.bz/nWa5). The CloudWatch agent already